FREE GUMROAD GUIDE

DM: PROMPT

Prompting Roadmap

0 to 100

A practical roadmap to write prompts that produce real outputs: captions, study plans, research briefs, workflows, product specs, automations, and AI-built projects.

14-day challenge
Practice plan, not theory

Prompt templates
Copy-paste systems

Build with English
Turn ideas into specs

By Mudit Jain
@ai_with_mudit | For students, creators, freelancers, founders, and builders

01. Read this before you start

This guide is built for the person who DMed "prompt" and wants to actually get better, not collect another PDF.

THE CORE IDEA

A prompt is not a magic sentence. A prompt is a work order. The clearer the work order, the fewer ways the AI has to misunderstand you.

Do not chase fancy words

Better prompting is not about sounding smart. It is about defining the outcome, context, rules, and quality bar.

Practice on real tasks

Use this PDF on captions, notes, research, study plans, product ideas, and small tools. No imaginary practice.

Build proof

A good prompt creates something useful: a doc, post, brief, workflow, spec, page, script, or checklist.

Iterate

Your first answer is a draft. The skill is giving feedback, scoring output, and improving the instruction.

Bad goal vs better goal

Bad goal	Better goal
I want to learn prompting.	This week I want to create 10 captions, 1 research brief, 1 study plan, 1 workflow, and 1 website spec using AI.

Rule: Never judge a prompt by how intelligent it looks. Judge it by what it produces.

02. The 0 to 100 roadmap

Each level adds one skill. Do not jump to advanced prompts before learning clear outputs.



Level	Skill	What you should be able to do
0-10	Mental model	Understand prompting as instruction design, not keyword hacking.
10-25	Prompt anatomy	Write prompts with task, context, input, constraints, and output format.
25-40	Context engineering	Give the background that changes the answer without dumping irrelevant details.
40-55	Output control	Force structure: tables, scripts, checklists, JSON, emails, plans, specs.
55-70	Examples and iteration	Use examples, scoring, critique, and rewrite loops to improve results.
70-85	Workflow prompting	Chain prompts into repeatable systems for content, study, research, business, and coding.
85-100	Building with English	Write specs AI can turn into pages, tools, automations, and MVPs.

How you know you are improving

From vague to precise

You stop asking "give me something good" and start saying: "Give me 5 options, each under 12 words, written for Indian students, with curiosity, no clickbait, and a clear reason to save."

Use this guide in 3 passes

1. Read the levels.
2. Copy the templates onto real tasks.
3. Build 3 proof projects from the final section.

What not to do

Do not save this and forget it. Pick one bad prompt today. Rewrite it using the 6-part anatomy. Then compare output quality.

03. Level 0-10: The real meaning of a prompt

At this level your job is simple: stop being vague. Every useful prompt answers five questions.

Task
What should the AI create or decide?

Audience
Who is the output for?

Context
What does the AI need to know?

Format
What should the final answer look like?

Quality bar
How will you judge if it is good?

Weak prompt -> strong prompt

Weak prompt	Strong prompt
Write a caption about AI.	Write an Instagram caption for Indian students who save AI workflow content. First line should make the value clear. Give 5 hashtags max. Tone: direct, Hinglish-friendly, not generic gyaan.

Exercise: upgrade one prompt in 3 minutes

Copy-paste worksheet

```
Weak prompt: [paste your prompt]
My audience: [who this is for]
My desired output: [what should be created]
Context: [what the AI must know]
Rules: [length, tone, format, things to avoid]
Success criteria: [how I will judge if it is good]
```

One-minute prompt test
Before you press enter, ask: "Could a stranger understand what I want without reading my mind?" If not, add audience, context, output format, and success criteria.

The beginner mistake
Most people give the AI a topic. Skilled users give the AI a job, a user, a format, rules, and a definition of good.

Beginner win: If the AI output improves after you add audience, format, and success criteria, you are already prompting better than most people.

04. Level 10-25: Learn the prompt anatomy

This beginner formula works for almost every task. You do not need all six parts every time, but quality work needs structure.

Role + Task + Context + Input + Output format + Constraints

Think of this as briefing a talented intern who joined your team today.

Role

Act as a social media strategist.

Task

Create 10 reel hooks.

Context

Audience: Indian students and creators learning AI.

Input

Topic: English is the new coding language.

Output format

Table with hook, reason, risk.

Constraints

No cringe. No corporate tone. Max 9 words per hook.

Universal template

Copy this when quality matters

```
Act as [role].
Your task: [specific task].
Context: [audience, goal, situation, background].
Input: [paste the material or idea].
Output format: [table / bullets / script / checklist / JSON / plan].
Constraints: [tone, length, style, things to avoid].
Before final answer, check the output against: [success criteria].
```

When to use the full formula

Use all 6 parts for important outputs: client work, posts, code, study plans, decisions, research, or anything you will publish.

When to stay simple

For quick answers, use only task + context + format. Example: "Summarize this in 5 bullets for a beginner."

Upgrade: Add "make reasonable assumptions, but list them before answering" when you do not want the AI to ask too many questions.

05. Level 25-40: Context engineering

Context is not more words. Context is the information that changes the answer.

Do not dump everything

Long messy paragraphs make the model guess what matters. Dumping raw information is not the same as briefing.

Separate your context

Use headings: Goal, Audience, Assets, Constraints, Examples, What to avoid. This makes the model follow your priorities.

Context blocks that usually change the answer

Audience

Age, pain points, language, platform, skill level.

Goal

Save, share, reply, buy, understand, build, decide.

Current situation

What exists now and what you are trying to improve.

Style references

Examples you like and dislike.

Non-negotiables

Rules the output must follow.

Assets

Clips, screenshots, data, notes, transcript, links.

Context block template

```
Use the context below to create the output.
Goal: [what I want]
Audience: [who this is for]
Current situation: [what is happening now]
Assets available: [links, clips, notes, screenshots, data]
Style I want: [examples]
Avoid: [things that will make output bad]
Now create: [specific output]
```

06. Level 40-55: Control the output

Good prompts tell the model what "done" looks like. If you want a table, checklist, script, JSON, or copy-paste version, say it.

Use case	Output format to request
Decision	Comparison table with recommendation, tradeoffs, and final call.
Learning	Roadmap, daily drills, checkpoints, mistakes, revision plan.
Content	Hook, script, caption, pinned comment, hashtags, thumbnail text.
Coding	Product spec, folder structure, files to change, tests, acceptance criteria.
Research	Summary, sources, counterpoints, uncertainty, action points.
Business	Offer, target customer, problem, objections, sales script, next step.

Exact format commands you should steal

For clean answers

```
Give the answer in this exact format:
1. Final answer
2. Why this works
3. What could go wrong
4. How to improve it
5. Copy-paste version
```

For decisions

```
Make a 3-column table: Option, Pros, Cons. Then give one recommendation and explain the tradeoff in plain English.
```

For content

```
Give 10 options. Each under 12 words. Score them out of 10 for curiosity, clarity, and shareability. Rewrite the top 3.
```

For builders

```
Give user flow, screens, components, database fields, edge cases, acceptance criteria, and tests.
```

Output control is the fastest way to stop getting messy AI answers.

07. Level 55-70: Use examples and iteration

One example can be worth 500 words of instruction. Examples reduce randomness and make the output closer to your taste.

Without examples	With examples
The model uses its default internet voice.	The model copies your structure, pacing, sharpness, and style patterns without copying exact lines.

The 3-step loop

1. Generate

Ask for 10-20 options so you have range.

2. Score

Tell it to score against clear criteria.

3. Rewrite

Rewrite the top options with specific improvements.

Example-based prompt

```
Here are 3 examples of my preferred style:
Example 1: [paste]
Example 2: [paste]
Example 3: [paste]
Pattern to copy: direct, specific, not generic, useful enough to save.
Do not copy exact lines. Extract the structure, pacing, and tone.
Now create 10 new versions for this topic: [topic].
After generating, score each out of 10 and explain the score in one line.
```

Feedback words that actually help

Too generic

Ask: make it more specific with examples, names, steps, and constraints.

Too long

Ask: compress to half the length without losing the useful parts.

Too boring

Ask: increase curiosity while keeping it honest and useful.

Wrong tone

Ask: rewrite like a sharp creator speaking to Indian students, not a corporate blog.

Use this as a work order system: outcome, context, constraints, format, criteria.

08. Level 70-85: Turn prompts into workflows

The real skill is not one perfect prompt. It is a repeatable process that turns inputs into assets.

Input -> Process prompts -> Review -> Final asset

Do not stop at ideas. Turn answers into something usable.

Content workflow

Idea -> hooks -> script -> caption -> pinned comment -> thumbnail text -> final post

Study workflow

Topic -> simple explanation -> examples -> active recall -> test -> weak areas -> revision plan

Research workflow

Question -> source list -> summary -> counterpoints -> uncertainty -> action checklist

Build workflow

Idea -> user problem -> feature list -> screen map -> product spec -> code prompt -> tests

Workflow designer template

```
Create a repeatable workflow for [goal].
My input will usually be: [what I have].
My final output should be: [asset].
Design the workflow as 5 prompts. For each prompt, give:
- Purpose
- Copy-paste prompt
- What good output should look like
- What to do after the output
```

Use this as a work order system: outcome, context, constraints, format, criteria.

09. Level 85-100: Building with English

This is where "English is the new coding language" becomes practical. You are not just prompting. You are writing specs.

If you tell AI "make me an app," it will guess. If you give a product spec, it can execute far better.

A basic product spec should include

User type

Who uses it and why.

Core action

The one thing the product must help them do.

Screens

Every screen/page needed.

Data

What information is stored.

Rules

What should and should not happen.

Edge cases

Empty states, errors, duplicates, permissions.

Definition of done

How to test if it works.

Constraints

Tech, style, timeline, must-have features.

Mini spec example

```
Product: Study timer for students.
User: distracted college student.
Core flow: choose subject -> start timer -> log
session -> view weekly streak.
Edge cases: pause, abandon, no subject selected.
```

Why this matters

Coding agents do better when you describe screens, states, data, errors, and done criteria. That is the difference between "vibe coding" and clear building.

AI coding agent spec prompt

```
I want to build [product/tool].
User: [who it is for]
Problem: [what pain it solves]
Core flow: [step 1 -> step 2 -> step 3]
Screens needed: [list]
Data needed: [list]
Rules and edge cases: [list]
Now turn this into a clear product specification for an AI coding agent. Include files,
components, user flow, acceptance criteria, and test cases.
```

10. Copy-paste prompt templates: everyday work

Replace the brackets. Keep the structure. Use these when you want useful output fast.

Prompt improver

Improve this prompt so it produces a more specific, useful, and reliable output. Ask up to 3 clarifying questions only if absolutely necessary. Otherwise, make reasonable assumptions and give the upgraded prompt. Prompt: [paste]

Expert feedback

Act as a strict but useful expert in [field]. Review my output. Tell me what is weak, missing, generic, and how to make it 10/10. Then rewrite the final version. Output: [paste]

Caption engine

Create an Instagram caption for [audience] about [topic]. First line must clearly explain why to read the caption. Make it save-worthy, specific, and not generic gyaan. Add 5 hashtags max. Give copy-paste format.

Study coach

Teach me [topic] from scratch. First explain it simply, then give examples, then test me with 10 active recall questions, then create a revision plan based on my weak answers.

Research brief

Research [topic] using reliable sources I provide or can verify. Give summary, key points, counterpoints, uncertainty, and actions I can take.

Decision helper

I need to decide between [options]. Ask only essential questions. Then give a comparison table, tradeoffs, recommendation, and the risk if I choose wrong.

11. Advanced templates for builders

Use these when you want to create assets, systems, specs, automations, and workflows - not just answers.

Workflow designer

Design a repeatable AI workflow for [goal]. It should take this input: [input]. It should produce this output: [output]. Give each step, exact prompt for each step, and the quality check after each step.

Spec writer

Turn this idea into a product spec for an AI coding tool. Include user story, screens, components, database fields, edge cases, acceptance criteria, and tests. Idea: [idea]

Automation mapper

I currently do this manually: [process]. Break it into steps. Identify what can be automated with AI, what needs human review, what tools might be needed, and the first free/no-code version I can test.

Deep critique loop

Give me 3 versions of the output. Then act as a critic and reject weak parts. Then combine the strongest parts into one final version. Topic/input: [paste]

Style cloning safely

Analyze the writing style of the examples below. Extract structure, pacing, vocabulary, sentence length, and tone. Do not copy exact lines. Create original output on [topic] in a similar structural style. Examples: [paste]

Agent instruction

You are an AI assistant for [goal]. Your job is to [task]. Ask clarifying questions only when blocked. Follow these rules: [rules]. Output must be: [format]. Success criteria: [criteria].

Use this as a work order system: outcome, context, constraints, format, criteria.

12. Real-world examples: weak prompt to useful prompt

This page is here so the guide feels usable, not theoretical. Copy the pattern and change the niche.

Creator

Weak: Give me reel ideas.
Strong: Give me 10 reel ideas for Indian students learning AI. Each idea must have a hook, 20-second script angle, caption value, and why someone would save it. Avoid generic productivity advice.

Student

Weak: Explain DBMS.
Strong: Teach me DBMS normalization for an exam. Explain in simple words, give 3 examples, create 10 active recall questions, then give common mistakes and a 2-day revision plan.

Founder

Weak: Make my app idea better.
Strong: I am building a turf booking app for Jaipur. Users need discovery, real-time slots, payments, and teams. Analyze the idea, list user flows, MVP screens, risks, and the first version I can test in 7 days.

Coding

Weak: Build a website.
Strong: Create a landing page spec for a free prompting guide. Include sections, copy, CTA, form fields, mobile layout, success states, and implementation steps for a coding agent.

The pattern: weak prompt asks for a topic. Strong prompt defines audience, goal, output format, constraints, and use case.

13. The 14-day prompting challenge

Do this and you will improve faster than watching 50 reels. Every day must create proof.

Day	Task	Proof to create
1	Rewrite 5 vague prompts using the 6-part anatomy.	Before/after prompt doc
2	Create 10 hooks for one reel idea and score them.	Hook bank
3	Make one study plan for a hard topic.	7-day study plan
4	Summarize one long article/video into action points.	1-page brief
5	Create one caption using audience/context constraints.	Copy-paste caption
6	Use examples to match your style.	3 style-matched outputs
7	Ask AI to critique your own prompt.	Improved prompt
8	Build a content workflow.	5-step prompt chain
9	Build a research workflow.	Research prompt chain
10	Write a product spec for a tiny tool.	MVP spec
11	Ask AI to find edge cases in the spec.	Edge case list
12	Create acceptance criteria and tests.	Testing checklist
13	Turn one AI output into a real asset.	Post, doc, page, script, tool
14	Review everything and create your personal prompt library.	Prompt library v1

How to run it

Pick one AI tool and one notes app. Every day, paste the task, create the proof, and save the final prompt.

What to save

Save the prompt, output, and your feedback. This becomes your personal prompt library.

The real win

By day 14, you should have assets, not motivation: hooks, docs, briefs, specs, and workflows.

Proof project ideas

1. AI content system
2. Study operating system
3. Research brief machine
4. Tiny product spec
5. Personal prompt library

Do not skip review

After every task, ask AI: "What made this prompt work? What should I reuse next time?" That is how you compound skill.

Challenge rule: If there is no proof, it was content consumption, not skill building.

14. Prompt troubleshooting matrix

When the output is bad, do not blame the model immediately. Fix the instruction first.

Problem	Likely cause	Fix
Generic answer	No audience, goal, or examples.	Add audience, constraints, and 2 examples.
Too long	No length limit.	Set word, line, or section limit.
Wrong tone	No style direction.	Add tone, examples, and avoid list.
Misses details	Context not separated.	Use headings: Goal, Input, Rules, Output.
Makes things up	No source rules.	Ask it to cite sources or say not sure.
Messy output	No format specified.	Request exact table, checklist, or template.
Does not improve	No feedback loop.	Ask it to score and rewrite against criteria.

The 20-minute prompt upgrade routine

Minute 0-3

Write the messy prompt normally.

Minute 3-7

Add audience, context, constraints, and output format.

Minute 7-12

Ask AI to critique the prompt before answering.

Minute 12-16

Run the improved prompt and score the output.

Minute 16-20

Rewrite once using specific feedback and save the final prompt.

Troubleshooting prompt

```
The output below is not good enough. Diagnose why.
My original prompt: [paste]
AI output: [paste]
My goal: [goal]
Tell me what was missing from the prompt. Then rewrite the prompt and produce the improved output.
```

15. The 100-point prompt checklist

Before sending an important prompt, score it quickly. The final judge is always output quality.

Points	Checklist item	Your score
10	Task is specific enough that a stranger can understand it.	__/10
10	Audience or user is defined.	__/10
10	Context is separated and relevant.	__/10
10	Input material is included or clearly described.	__/10
10	Output format is exact.	__/10
10	Constraints are clear: length, tone, style, rules.	__/10
10	Examples are included when style matters.	__/10
10	Success criteria are included.	__/10
10	The prompt asks for review, scoring, or iteration when quality matters.	__/10
10	The final output becomes an asset, not just an idea.	__/10

Quick scoring example

```
Prompt: "make a study plan"
Score: 30/100.
Missing: audience, exam date, current level,
subject, format, schedule, success criteria.
Better: add all of those before asking.
```

Prompt library format

```
Title: [use case]
Prompt: [copy-paste]
Best output: [link or paste]
Why it worked: [1 line]
When to reuse: [situation]
```

Use the checklist only for important prompts. For casual answers, do not over-engineer. For assets, code, research, and public posts, score the prompt before sending.

Score rule

Below 60: rewrite the prompt.
60-80: usable, but add context or format.
80-100: strong enough to test.
100 does not mean perfect. It means clear enough to execute.

Build your prompt library

Save prompts in 5 folders:
1. Content
2. Study
3. Research
4. Business
5. Building/coding

Add examples of outputs that worked.

16. Free resource vault

Everything here is free to access or has a free learning option at the time of writing. Some platforms may require login. Certificates may cost.

01 **OpenAI Help Center: prompt engineering best practices**

Official rules of thumb: put instructions first, be specific, define format, use examples.

https://help.openai.com/en/articles/6654000-best-practices-for-prompt-engineering-with-openai-api

02 **Anthropic Claude Docs: prompt engineering overview**

Great for success criteria, prompt chaining, examples, XML-style structure, and iteration.

https://docs.anthropic.com/en/docs/build-with-claude/prompt-engineering/overview

03 **DeepLearning.AI: ChatGPT Prompt Engineering for Developers**

Beginner course by Isa Fulford and Andrew Ng. Free learning option shown during platform beta.

https://www.deeplearning.ai/courses/chatgpt-prompt-eng

04 **Coursera: Prompt Engineering for ChatGPT by Vanderbilt**

Longer structured course. Use free/audit option if available in your region. Do not buy certificate unless you want it.

https://www.coursera.org/learn/prompt-engineering

05 **PromptingGuide.ai**

Free written guide with techniques, examples, papers, and advanced concepts.

https://www.promptingguide.ai/

06 **Google Cloud Skills: Prompt Engineering Guide**

Introductory Google course for prompting Gemini responses.

https://www.skills.google/course_templates/1132

07 **Google Workspace: Gemini Prompt Guide**

Free role-based prompting guide for everyday work use cases.

https://workspace.google.com/learning/content/gemini-prompt-guide

08 **YouTube: ChatGPT Prompt Engineering for Developers short course**

Video reference for people who prefer watching before practicing.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=H4YK_7MAckk

17. Final note: the real skill

The future belongs to people who can explain work clearly and ship fast.

The new coding language is not only English. It is clear thinking written in English.

AI makes vague people create vague output faster. But it gives clear people leverage. If you can define the outcome, constraints, context, examples, and quality bar, you can use AI to create things that used to need a team.

Your next step

1. **Pick one real task today.**
2. **Use the universal template from this PDF.**
3. **Turn the answer into a real asset: a post, study plan, workflow, doc, or tiny product spec.**
4. **Save the final prompt in your personal prompt library.**

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